

ISHWARYA SURESH

Product Designer & UX Researcher

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Designer and UX Researcher with end-to-end experience across web and mobile, from research and discovery through user flows, wireframes, high-fidelity UI, design systems, and coded prototypes. I work across both sides of the craft: deep qualitative research (interviews, usability testing, contextual inquiry, synthesis) and the design and prototyping that turns insight into shipped product. Recent focus on consumer fintech, including a personal-finance product with three switchable visual systems off one token contract and an explainable decisioning tool, both built as working coded prototypes. Evidence-based in practice, prototyping by default, and accessibility-led to WCAG and GDS standards across 200+ Local Authorities.

CORE SKILLS

Product & Interaction Design: User Flows, Wireframing, Prototyping, Coded Prototypes (React), High-Fidelity UI, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Responsive Web and Mobile Design, UI Specifications

UX Research: User Interviews, Usability Testing, Contextual Inquiry, Diary Studies, Ethnographic Studies, Co-Design Workshops, Surveys, Competitive Analysis, Thematic Analysis, Affinity Mapping, Persona Development, Journey Mapping

Visual & Systems: Visual Design, Typography, Grids, Layout, Design Systems, Design Tokens, Component Libraries, Iconography

Strategy & Collaboration: Evidence-Based Design, Research Prioritisation, Stakeholder Management, Cross-Functional Collaboration (Design, Engineering, Product), Insight-Framed Reporting, Workshop Facilitation, Mentoring

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, WCAG 2.2, Colour and Contrast, Keyboard and Focus States, Screen-Reader Testing, Inclusive Design, GDS Standards

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Sketch, Framer, InVision, Principle, Miro, React, Cursor, Dovetail, Hotjar, Tableau, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product Designer & UX Researcher | MadeForHumans (Independent Consultancy)

May 2025 to Present | United Kingdom (Remote) | Full-Time

- Founded an independent product design consultancy delivering product and interaction design, discovery and strategy, and accessibility services to startups, studios, and SMEs.
- Lead engagements end-to-end: discovery, user flows, wireframes, high-fidelity UI in Figma, coded prototypes, and developer handover.
- Run discovery through stakeholder interviews, usability tests, opportunity mapping, and north-star metrics; embed WCAG 2.2 accessibility from the first wireframe, not as a sprint-end audit.
- Delivered an architecture studio website in Framer with research-driven IA, case-study templates, and user flows from stakeholder interviews.

Selected project: Kaizen, Consumer Finance Product (2026)

- Took a consumer finance product (budgeting, goals, and investing) end-to-end, from a competitive audit and evidence-based personas through user flows, high-fidelity UI, and a working coded React prototype across 8 screens.
- Built a scalable design system: 3 switchable visual directions off one token contract, plus a full component and icon library, demonstrating visual craft and systems thinking.

Selected project: Ledgerline, Explainable Decisioning Tool (2026)

- Ran a full research-to-prototype cycle: 6 structured interviews, competitive analysis, and synthesis of 74 observations into 4 insights, then designed and built a working coded prototype with hand-rolled SVG charts.
- Validated through task-based testing with 3 domain professionals, one of whom asked if it was connected to live data.

User Researcher | Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government (MHCLG)

July 2024 to April 2025 | Newcastle upon Tyne, United Kingdom (Hybrid) | Full-Time

- Led UX strategy for UK government grants services to Government Design System (GDS) standards, improving usability and achieving WCAG 2.1 AA compliance across 200+ Local Authorities.
- Planned and ran surveys, semi-structured interviews, and moderated usability testing; analysed findings through thematic and affinity mapping.
- Maintained ResearchOps and governance practices; presented insights and service design recommendations to senior stakeholders, influencing product roadmaps with data-informed decisions.
- Worked within an agile team of service designers, product managers, and developers to integrate user insights into delivery.

UX Consultant | Freelance (Self-Employed)

September 2023 to April 2025 | United Kingdom (Remote) | Full-Time

- Delivered end-to-end product and interaction design for clients across healthcare, education, and tech; embedded with founder and product teams.
- Led discovery through stakeholder interviews, competitive analysis, and user research; produced opportunity maps and roadmaps.
- Led design for a healthcare mobile app: mapped IA and simplified navigation in Figma, increasing engagement by 15%.
- Redesigned a remote-learning platform: prototyped interactive flows and refined content design, increasing course completion by 20%.
- Embedded WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility into early design: contrast, keyboard and focus, screen-reader, and cognitive load.

UX Designer / Researcher | Novacraft

August 2023 to September 2023 | United Kingdom (Remote) | Contract

- Led UX for the Transport for London (TfL) Care Leaver Oyster Card campaign, applying inclusive design to increase accessibility and adoption.
- Ran a full research and design cycle: persona development, journey mapping, and prototyping in InVision.
- Partnered with stakeholders to validate design solutions and worked with development teams on implementation.

User Research Intern | Nebula Labs

February 2023 to April 2023 | United Kingdom (On-site) | Internship

- Led a research project for the Me & You digital app to enhance quality of life for people living with dementia.
- Synthesised interviews, field studies, and co-design workshops into actionable design strategies for patients and carers.
- Collaborated with academics from Newcastle and Northumbria Universities, validating insights through focus groups.

UX Designer | Freelance (Self-Employed)

April 2021 to February 2023 | United Kingdom (Remote) | Part-Time

- Delivered UX design and research for clients across multiple sectors alongside postgraduate studies, producing wireframes and prototypes in Figma and Sketch.
- Conducted user research, usability testing, and competitive analysis to inform user-centred designs.

UX/UI Design Intern | AnywhereWorks / FULL Creative

January 2021 to March 2021 | Chennai, India (On-site) | Internship

- Redesigned the AnywhereWorks platform UI and built a design system and style guide, improving brand consistency and reducing development time.
- Simplified onboarding workflows for the Switchboard app, increasing user activation rates.

EDUCATION

MSc Human Computer Interaction | Newcastle University | 2021 to 2022 | Newcastle upon Tyne, UK

- Specialised in Interaction Design, UX Research Methods, and Prototyping.
- Dissertation: co-designed and evaluated an ambient air quality sensing technology for workplace well-being, in collaboration with a PhD researcher.
- Dissertation work acknowledged in a paper accepted at the ACM CHI 2024 Conference.

Bachelor of Architecture (B.Arch) | Anna University | 2015 to 2020 | Chennai, India

- Built a strong foundation in design thinking, sustainable design, and systems-level problem-solving.